

Are You Waiting For Another Pandemic To Have A Digital Strategy?

The year 2020 was one of the biggest—if not the biggest—in terms of challenges that industries and businesses faced worldwide. Among these, the hardest hit were the manufacturing industries and all the other verticals of businesses that require people to be present on the work-floor



Mukul Yudhveer Singh

The effects of the coronavirus and the events that followed its outbreak were so ruinous that the State Bank of India has projected contraction of over 40 percent in India's GDP in the first quarter of financial year 2021. Considering the fact that India's manufacturing industry contributes 16 to 17 percent to India's GDP, was it possible to minimise this drop in GDP without compromising the health of people and affecting the nation's progress?

A new McKinsey survey suggests there were three kinds of outcomes: A win for companies that had already embraced digital technologies, a reality check for those that were still adopting, and a wake-up call for those who had not yet started on their industry 4.0 journey. Over 94 percent of industry leaders who took part in a survey conducted

by McKinsey regarding industry 4.0 said that the Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT) had helped them keep their operations running during the crisis.

Sreenath C. Lakshmanan, CEO and founder of i4DigitalValue says, "It is very well known that the economies are grinding towards recession. Post pandemic, it could shrink further down. The most important thing for organisations is to take critical decisions in order to mitigate all the challenges. How we leverage technologies like Industrial Internet of Things, AI, ML, and Big Data to create new pathways for the organisations is of utmost importance now."

He adds, "Strategy, and especially digital strategy, becomes very important because we are functioning in the middle of a pandemic era now. Like there was a